

# Diagnostics waiting over six weeks

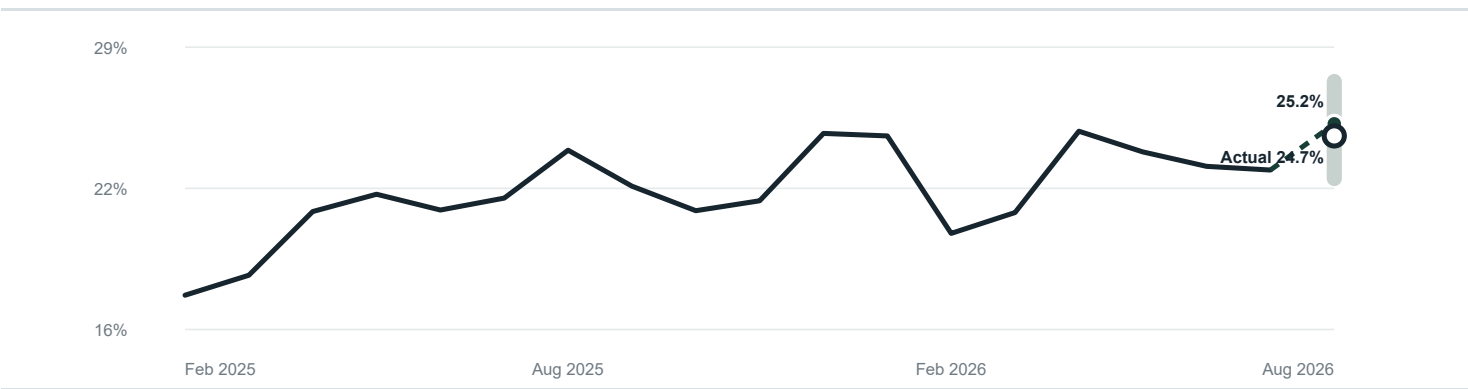
Outturn for August 2026 · forecast issued with data through July 2026

The published result was 24.7%. It was 0.5pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range. The provider distribution and trajectory watch have been refreshed using the new release.

|                                                                                            |                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>LATEST · JULY 2026</div> <div>23.1%</div> <div>No archived pre-release forecast</div> | <div>OUTLOOK · AUGUST 2026</div> <div>25.2%</div> <div>80% range 22.7%–27.2%</div> | <div>ACTUAL</div> <div>24.7%</div> <div>0.5pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range</div> <div>Off course · 14% or less by March 2027</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

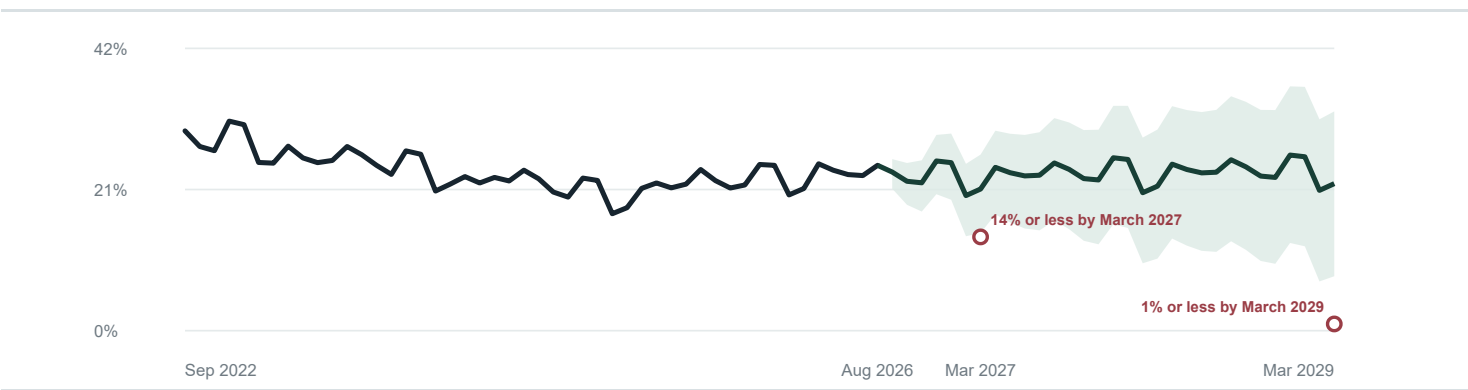
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



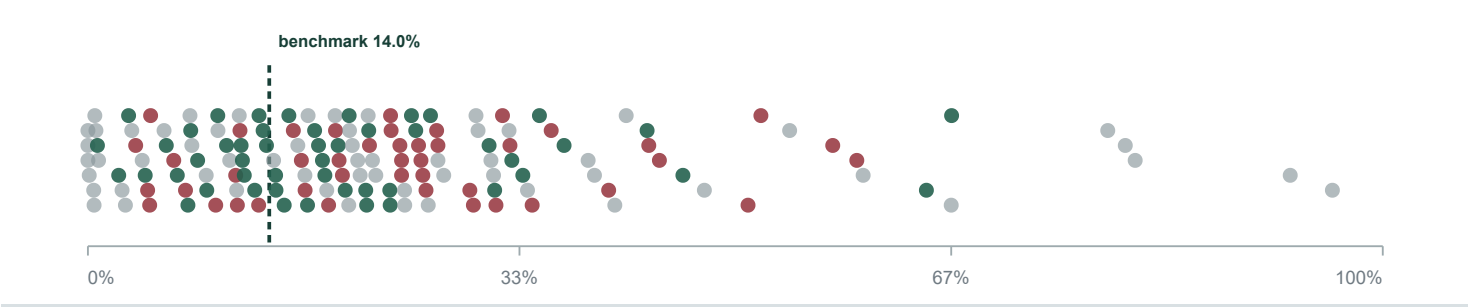
**Benchmark:** 1% operational standard. 7.3pp above milestone  
**Data:** NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework national target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target  
**Method:** Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 248 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · July 2026

## Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



## Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                       |                                                                                                                                                               |                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 142<br>providers assessed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 49<br>sustained favourable            | 44<br>sustained adverse                                                                                                                                       | 49<br>without an active signal        |
| Largest sustained favourable moves                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                       | Largest sustained adverse moves                                                                                                                               |                                       |
| West London NHS Trust<br>Latest 64.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 35.3pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH | Royal Papworth Hospital NHS Foundation Trust<br>Latest 59.4% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest        | 34.9pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH |
| Royal Surrey NHS Foundation Trust<br>Latest 12.1% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 31.5pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH | Dorset Healthcare University NHS Foundation Trust<br>Latest 34.3% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest   | 21.0pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH |
| King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust<br>Latest 19.9% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 26.0pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH | East Kent Hospitals University NHS Foundation Trust<br>Latest 52.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier<br>fixed six month path backtest | 19.9pp<br>AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH |
| Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality. |                                       |                                                                                                                                                               |                                       |